全民英檢中級 GEPT Intermediate | 第 15 單元

政府、法律與社會 · Government, Law & Society

Three Days That Changed My Mind About Politics

改變我對政治看法的三天

Monday. Until this week, I thought politics was something that only happened on the TV news. Then the mayor announced a new regulation that will prohibit scooters on Dihua Street, where my family has run a tea shop for thirty years. Dad was furious. "They need a permit to repaint a wall, but a politician can change our whole street in one afternoon?" he shouted. A group of shopkeepers has decided to hold a protest on Wednesday, and Dad is one of its loudest supporters.

Wednesday. The protest was not what I expected. About two hundred people gathered outside the city hall holding signs, but nobody was violent. A city representative came out to listen, and she explained that the restriction was part of a wider reform to make the old district safer for pedestrians. A recent poll showed that 60 percent of residents supported it. Dad still opposed the plan, but I noticed that the opposition was not united. Some shopkeepers only wanted longer delivery hours; others wanted the whole rule cancelled.

Friday. Tonight Dad and I read the full text of the regulation online. It turns out that delivery scooters with a special license will still be permitted before ten in the morning. The city will also use part of its welfare budget to help elderly shop owners move their goods. Dad admitted the plan was not as unfair as he had thought, although he still believes the mayor should have asked the shopkeepers first. I used to think political arguments were just noise. Now I understand that behind every regulation are real people, each with a different idea of what liberty means. Maybe I will study political science after all.

重點單字 Key Vocabulary

單字	詞性	中文	例句
regulation	*n.*	規定；法規	The new regulation limits the use of plastic bags. 新規定限制塑膠袋的使用。
prohibit	*v.*	禁止	Smoking is prohibited in all MRT stations. 所有捷運站都禁止吸菸。

politician	*n.*	政治人物	The politician promised to build more parks. 這位政治人物承諾興建更多公園。
protest	*n.*	抗議	Hundreds of farmers joined the protest against the new tax. 數百名農民加入了反對新稅的抗議。
supporter	*n.*	支持者	Thousands of supporters cheered for the team at the airport. 數千名支持者在機場為球隊歡呼。
representative	*n.*	代表	A representative of the company answered our questions. 一位公司代表回答了我們的問題。
reform	*n.*	改革	The education reform changed how students are tested. 這項教育改革改變了學生的評量方式。
poll	*n.*	民意調查	The poll shows most people want a new library. 民調顯示大多數人想要一座新圖書館。
opposition	*n.*	反對；反對者	The plan met with strong opposition from local residents. 這項計畫遭到當地居民強烈反對。
welfare	*n.*	福利	The government spends billions on social welfare every year. 政府每年花費數十億在社會福利上。

片語 Phrases

turn out (that)	結果發現；原來	It turned out that the test had been cancelled. 結果發現考試已經取消了。
be part of	是…的一部分	Cleaning the classroom is part of our daily routine. 打掃教室是我們每日例行事務的一部分。
after all	畢竟；終究	I decided to go to the party after all. 我終究還是決定去參加派對。

文法與句型 Grammar

S + be + not as + adj. + as + S + had thought

「不如…原本以為的那麼…」，as...as 表示同等比較，否定時表示程度不及；had thought 用過去完成式表示「先前以為」。文章第三段：the plan was not as unfair as he had thought.

The exam was not as difficult as I had thought.

考試沒有我原本以為的那麼難。

S + should have + p.p.

「當時應該…（但沒有）」，用來表示對過去行為的批評或遺憾。文章第三段：the mayor should have asked the shopkeepers first.

You should have told me about the meeting earlier.

你當時應該早點告訴我開會的事。

讀完文章後，請到「皇家大衛英文閱讀集點站」完成本單元測驗，答對即可累積點數。